



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

SPRING 2022

Worship in April, May, and June

Easter is later in the calendar this year, and we are going to take advantage of that by trying to have an outdoor service at 11:00! Weather permitting, the 11:00 service will be in our side lawn on April 17. If the weather doesn't permit, then we will be inside. We are adapting our schedule for a variety of events in May and June, so here is what our schedule will look like after Easter:

- April 10 -- Palm Sunday! Services at 9:00 and 11:00, inside. Palm Processional outside at 10:15. Baptism of Grace Nelson at the 11:00 service.
- April 15 -- Good Friday. Tenebrae service in the sanctuary at 7:00 p.m.
- April 17 -- Easter! 9:00 service inside, 11:00 outside (indoors if weather is bad).
- April 24 -- one service at 10:00, inside. We will celebrate Joy/Humor. If you want to dress funny, you are welcome to do so! We will also receive new members.
- May 1 -- Services at 9:00 and 11:00, inside. Bibles given to 2nd graders at both services.
- May 8 -- Mother's Day! Services at 9:00 and 11:00 inside.
- May 15 -- Services at 9:00 and 11:00, inside. Baptism of Kyler Hicks at the 9:00 service.
- May 22 -- One service at 10:00, inside. Celebration of our Children and Youth Programs.
- May 29 -- Summer schedule begins. One service at 10:00, outside.
- June 5 -- Graduation Sunday! And, Jenia Strom's last Sunday as our Director of Children, Youth, and Families. One service at 10:00, outside. Celebration of our graduates with cake, then a potluck lunch following to honor Jenia. There will be a time for verbal tributes.
- June 12 -- One Service at 10:00, outside. We will bless bikes and receive new members.

Camping Sunday



Baptism of Archer James & Jack William



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Women United in Faith

Here's your news from the new Women United in Faith (United Methodist Women) unit of Minnehaha UMC.



United
Women
in Faith

We've been pretty busy during March and would like you to know this year's recipients of our annual Service Awards that were given out at our UMW Sunday (didn't know our name had changed until the week of the service and the programs were printed!). Great thanks to the choir and The Methodicals for wonderful music that Sunday; it's always great to hear "I Am Woman"! Our WUF service awards go to individuals who have served our church community in extra special ways and this year we honored those who have brought you our service throughout the pandemic:

This person started coming to Minnehaha about nine years ago and found a church home here. But it wasn't until the pandemic that most of us noticed his contributions to the church.

- It would be fair to say that this person is a behind-the-scenes techie guy and he has used his technical skills to help Minnehaha in many, many ways.
- He set up the church's YouTube channel, making it possible for all of us to watch services on our TVs, computers, phones and other devices.
- He's evaluated and recommended equipment—including cameras, controllers and other key components—for the live streaming system, which has been such an important part of keeping our Minnehaha community connected and church services online during the pandemic
- He was instrumental in upgrading the church building-wide WiFi access to high speed.
- He set up the church's Google Drive as well as Google questionnaires and other forms.
- Along with other folks, he helps fix problems with WiFi and live streaming.
- He has been on various committees, including Staff-Parish Relations and Trustees.
- And fun fact: He gave us all a birds-eye-view of the sanctuary in one of our pre-recorded church services by flying his drone through the sanctuary, as well as providing some pretty cool outdoor drone shots.
- Minnehaha is lucky to have this person who willingly shares his many talents to help our church community.
- In case you don't yet know, the man I am describing is **Pete Ketcham**, and I am delighted and honored to present the UMW Service Award to him.

(Presentation written by Jenny Ammerman, given at the service by Kitty Campbell)

This person can be found at the 11:00 service every Sunday sitting in the way back, at the camera; this person does the live streaming. Sometimes the computer or the internet or the camera doesn't want to cooperate. The tech equipment can be hard to run; things can go wrong. But, a witness told me when things do fail to work, this person has exhibited "Grace under Fire". She works through the bugs and figures it out, providing us with a live-streamed YouTube movie every week. It's wonderful.

This person is involved in many other things. She is an amazing seamstress and tailor. She sewed backpacks for the outer space themed "To Mars and Beyond" Vacation Bible School kids. She sews her own kids' snowsuits and jackets, too. She's made costumes for last summer's play.

She's been a part of a committee in the General Conference. She is on the Children's Council. The woman I am describing is **Leslie Bohl**.



(Continued on page 8)

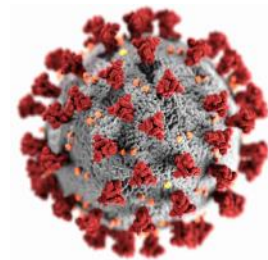


Worship Changes Related to Covid-19

You may remember that we set metrics in the fall about how Covid-19 numbers would affect how we gather. Recent changes in numbers have dropped us below some of our markers, so here is where we are currently:

- The choir began singing in January, 8 weeks after vaccinations were made available to 5-11 year olds.
- Congregational singing returned at the beginning of March, when the Hennepin County positivity rate dropped below 5%.
- We removed our distancing measures near the end of March when our 7 day average of new cases fell below 10/100,000 per day.
- We are continuing to be masked inside the building, for worship and in all our public spaces (individuals in a closed room together can make a group decision to remove masks as long as they remain in that room). Our marker for that was 7/100,000 new cases a day, and we are not there yet.

The Covid Task Force continues to meet. We evaluate where we are, look at our metrics, and may make more decisions on markers once vaccines are available for all ages. Stay tuned!



Easter Services

Join us for Easter Sunday on April 17. Our 9:00 service will be indoors and will feature the choir and organ (and the singing of the Hallelujah Chorus). The 11:00 service will be held outside (weather permitting) and will feature our band and vocals. We hope to see you on Easter morning!

Newcomer Class

We'll be holding an introduction and orientation class for anyone new to Minnehaha or interested in joining on Monday evening, May 2 at 6:30 p.m. You can come in person or attend via zoom; when you RSVP (becky@minnehaha.org), just let us know which way you'd like to attend.



APRIL & MAY



SUNDAY MORNING FAITH FORMATION

April 10th: Kids and their families are invited to join us for an outdoor Palm Processional in between services. We'll gather on the patio at 10:15, and then process together over to Nokomis Square before returning for fellowship

April 17th: Between the 9am (inside) and 11am (outside) services, families are invited to join us outside for Easter Activities (flower making, seed planting, a story walk, and more!)

April 24th: No Faith Formation - One Worship Service at 10am

May 1st, 8th, and 15th: Inside Faith Formation at 10:15

May 22nd: CELEBRATION SUNDAY featuring our children and youth - one service at 10am

MIDDLE SCHOOL & HIGH SCHOOL YOUTH GROUP

The schedule is a little wonky these last two months of the program year, so mark your calendars now so that you can be sure to join us.

April 10th: Youth Group from 4-5:30pm

April 17th: Easter - NO YOUTH GROUP

April 24th: Youth Group from 4-5:30pm

May 1st: Youth Group from 4-5:30pm

May 8th: Mother's Day - NO YOUTH GROUP

May 15th: Youth Group from 4-5:30pm

May 22nd: LAST YOUTH GROUP OF PROGRAM YEAR - 4-5:30pm

Summer Programming begins on June 5th.

Watch for details to come soon!



MANY THANKS TO ALL THOSE WHO MADE MPS STRIKE CHILDCARE POSSIBLE



We were so grateful for all those who made it possible for Minnehaha to provide a safe place for kids in our community to play during the Minneapolis teachers' strike. The flexibility, generosity, creativity, and compassion exhibited were much appreciated by families - some Minnehaha and some from our larger community.

Many thanks to Annette Sandager, Beth Minehart, Leah Palombo, Judi Bartlett, Katie Klug, Kendra Kramer, Casey Griffin, Amy Retherford, Kate Stower, Paige Gruenhagen, Ann Marie Johnson, Margaret Rawson, Ann Hall, Siri Strom, Jen Waters, Adam Schlosser, Raina Palombo, Eliza Schell, Colleen Netzell, Julie Darlington, Chris Kramer, Becca Fehr, Sue Johnson, Eric Strom, Caity Frail, Cindy Goehring, Lily O'Hara-Brantner, Scott Gruenhagen, Gail Minehart, Cullen Fehr, Jeff Sandager, Leslie Bohl, Susan Delattre, Patty Johntson, and Annette Meier

Minnehaha UMC 2022 Summer Camps



Compassion Camp: Changing the World With LovingKindness
An Evening Intergenerational Vacation Bible School

When: Monday, June 20-Thursdays, June 23 from 6-7:30pm
Where: Minnehaha Side Lawn
Who: Children with their Families, and People of All ages welcome & encouraged



Squirrels & Others:
Making a Musical, Saving the Animals
Minnehaha Music & Drama Camp

When: Monday, August 1-Friday, August 5th from 9-3pm
Evening Performance on Friday, August 5th
Where: Minnehaha Side Lawn
Who: Kids who have completed kindergarten through eighth grade



Minnehaha Youth to KoWaKan BWCA Base Camp Experience
When: Tuesday, July 12-Saturday, July 16
Where: KoWakan, Ely, MN
Who: Youth who have completed 5th-12th Grade



An all-ages Family Camping Weekend is in the works - watch for more information coming soon!



Camp Registration now open:
www.minnehaha.org



Holy Week Service

Holy Week is observed during the last week of Lent, between Palm Sunday (April 10) and Easter Sunday (April 17). It is traditionally a time to remember Jesus' entry into Jerusalem, his last supper with the disciples, and his arrest, trial and death.

We will have a Good Friday service on April 15. It will start at 7:00 and will include 14 readings from the gospel of Mark about the events leading up to Jesus' death. It also includes music, silence, and the extinguishing of lights.



Annual Meeting for Elected Positions

On Tuesday, May 31, we'll be holding a Charge Conference. That's the very specific (and required) United Methodist term for a meeting that is normally Church Council, but includes everyone. We'll meet in person and on zoom at 6:30 (the link will be in your weekly enews; contact becky@minnehaha.org if you need it sent to you), and the agenda will include the approval of our new list of committee members, as well as voting on the continuation of Sarah Schroerlucke as a candidate for ministry. Anyone can attend, and any member of the church is eligible to vote. Let Becky know if you have any questions.

*Next Newsletter
Deadline:
May 27
(goes out June 2)*

Will cover late June,
July & August

Water & weed.
Connect & laugh.
Wonder & appreciate.
Meet the worms.
Smell the oregano.
Watch the cucamelons climb.
Chase a butterfly.

We'll be planting together on May 22nd, and then will need help to tend the garden throughout the growing season. Individuals, families, people of all ages are welcome to join in! Questions? Contact Becca Fehr.



the
**MINNEHAHA
GARDEN**

**WE NEED YOUR HELP:
SIGN-UP TODAY
BY VISITING THE
MINNEHAHA WEBSITE.**

MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

Graduating this Year?

Will someone in your family graduate from high school, college, trade school, or grad school in 2022?

ON JUNE 5TH, AT OUR SERVICE AT 10AM, WE WILL BE RECOGNIZING GRADUATES IN OUR COMMUNITY.

PLEASE LET US KNOW ABOUT YOUR GRADUATE(S) BY THURSDAY, MAY 12TH TO BE INCLUDED IN THIS RECOGNITION.



Find the information form at
www.minnehaha.org
or email
education@minnehaha.org and
let us know names, schools,
and other pertinent
information so we can
celebrate you/your graduate.



Auctioning Your Talents

The Auction is back! On May 15 we will hold our Auction beginning at noon. The Youth are serving a picnic lunch (for purchase) from 12-12:45. If the weather is good, we'll be outside, with inside in the Fellowship Hall as a back-up plan. It's not too late to talk to Sue Claude about what service you might be able to offer. And, it's time to think about what items you might want to purchase! Have you wanted to go camping but don't have all the equipment? You could purchase a "camping outfitter" package! How about home-brewed beer? A fall yard work team? The possibilities are endless.

Come for the fun on May 15!

Celebration for Jenia!

Jenia's last Sunday as our Director of Children, Youth, and Families is Sunday, June 5. As you may remember, the Stroms are planning on staying at Minnehaha, but Jenia will no longer be on staff. We will celebrate her 11 years on staff with a party following worship on June 5. We are also celebrating graduates that day, so after the worship service and the cake for the graduates, everyone is invited to a potluck lunch in the side lawn. We'll eat together, and we'll also have a microphone available so people can share stories and tributes.

Update from Staff Parish Relations

Just a quick update from your SPR (the human resources team). We posted our Director of Children, Youth and Families position in a number of places, and are proceeding with interviews. We are hoping to be able to make an announcement to the congregation about the person who will be filling that role after Jenia leaves by the beginning of May.

AUCTION

SUNDAY, MAY 15

BACK TO OUR REGULARLY SCHEDULED PROGRAMMING

(Continued from page 2)

A third person has been at Minnehaha for about 10 years with his family. I understand that at Rally Day many years ago, he volunteered as a brand new parishioner here. He was welcomed to teach the 4-5 year olds as a Sunday School teacher. He's on the Children's Council. At Christmas time, his "Stars" have special pageant lights. In the back of the sanctuary are activity "bags" for which he buys supplies having his 4-5 year olds keep the bags filled.

This person is an active member of our Climate Action Committee. In 2021, he coordinated a session for our congregation to learn about community solar power and organized an electric vehicle showcase with owners for electric and hybrid vehicles.

This person coordinates and does the 9:00 service live-streaming. He volunteered his excellent skills during COVID-19, and has now recruited others to join him in making sure all our worship services are live-streamed.

We are blessed to have him here. If you don't know, I'm talking about **Jim Bohls**.

(These two recognitions of the Bohls' services were written and delivered by Kitty Campbell)

While we didn't give other service awards, we want to recognize the people who have kept our services online and available at home throughout COVID: Jefferson Slinkard, Anders Nelson, Sue Johnson, Renee Beymer, Kim Kanuit, Paul Minehart, Craig Johnson, Chris Kramer, Jason Emrick, Sybylla Yeoman Hendrix, Sue Claude, Jaxon Schroeder, Dexter Schroeder, and Cooper Cronquist.

Museum Field Trip

Eleven of us stopped into the Hennepin History Museum on Sat. March 19 to see the exhibit "Human Toll: A Public History of 35W" which certainly told the story of the deception about and destruction of that wide swath of land that cut through residential neighborhoods in the south Minneapolis. Many of those homes were occupied by Black families who had a hard time finding new homes in the redlined neighborhoods of the Twin Cities. Using photos, letters, interviews, news articles, and maps the story, similar to the Rondo neighborhood in St. Paul, destroyed by 194, was revealed. We later ate dinner together at a great Vietnamese restaurant on Nicollet, Quang's. As they say, a fine time was had by all!

Serving at Simpson

We continue to sponsor the monthly meals we serve at Simpson Shelter. In February, our servers were Char and Craig Johnson, Kevin Korell, Kitty Campbell, John Darlington and me. Susan Delattre and Dave Noren helped Margaret Rawson prepare the meal. We had enough leftovers to serve the same meal again on March 28 when our servers were Paula Barton, Jenny Ammerman, John Darlington, Kevin Korell and me. We are very grateful to be able to obtain some of the food for our meals at the Minneharvests the Saturday before we serve. We are able to serve 50 people with 6 servers so volunteer for a future date: April 27, May 31, June 27 or July 26. We meet at church to carpool at 5:30 or be at Simpson Shelter at 6:00 and usually finish by 8:00. We can always use cooks if you'd like to do that. Please contact Maureen Trepp at maurentrepp@yahoo.com.

Emma Norton Annual Event/ Silent Auction

Our United Methodist mission, Emma Norton Services, is having their annual dinner and silent auction, Opening Doors Gala on Thursday, April 28 at the InterContinental St. Paul Riverfront. The doors open at 4:30, dinner is served at 6:00 with a program following it. You can reserve your \$75 ticket at emmanorton.org. Emma Norton sponsors homes for women and women with their children.



Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us for our last service of this program year on May 13 for a time of renewal. The service is also livestreamed, so you can worship through your screen, wherever you are, either in real time or anytime after.

Summer Schedule

As we slowly work our way out of the Covid-19 Pandemic, we are going to have one more summer of just one service at 10:00, outside. If the weather is bad, the service will move into the sanctuary. As is now normal for all of our worship services, it will also be livestreamed. The musical style will be mixed, utilizing our musicians from both services. Assuming our infection numbers remain low, we will provide chairs again, but you are always welcome to bring your own camp chair or blanket for the lawn if that is more comfortable for you.

Our summer outdoor services will begin on May 29 (Memorial Day weekend) and continue through September 11 (our usual Sunday to celebrate the return to fall programming).

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. We gather outside on the 4th Saturday of each month. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the truck starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend! We'll be offering food on April 23 and May 28.

Trustees Looking for Feedback

What: Trustees Committee is soliciting feedback on the needs of the church. This includes the building and grounds, equipment and assets of the church. Your feedback will help inform us of how to prioritize our time and resources to best address the needs of our community. You can funnel feedback through Jeff Sandager (chair) of the Trustees, or any other member of the committee.

Who: You! Or anyone else that wants to help improve how we care for and invest in the church buildings and grounds

When: At 11AM on Sunday April 24th (after the one church service, there's no Sunday school)

Where: We will be doing a walk-through of the church building and grounds at 11AM on Sunday after the service at 10AM to review and document things that need attention. Meet in the Narthex at that time.

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2022 General Assembly

We are very excited to announce your chance to attend this year's WUF's General Assembly on May 20-21 with the theme "Turn it Up!". This event occurs every four years, bringing together women from around the country and world to a city's convention center for worship, education, socializing and community. The event in 2022 will be in Orlando, FL but we have been able to purchase the virtual experience, attending several of the sessions via streaming. We are planning on viewing an event on Friday: "New Wineskins: The New Brand and How to Share" from 12:30-2:00 p.m. and on Saturday: "Putting the Fun in Fundraising: How to Leave a Legacy" from 2:30-4:00 p.m. at Minnehaha UMC. There will also be large gatherings and worship services on those days and we will post the times in our E-news when we learn the times. We welcome anyone who would like to join us. Please contact Kim Kanuit at 612-860-0256 or kanuitkk@q.com if you are interested.

Looking to get rid of some of that rummage you've found around? We're planning on having a fall rummage sale from September 15-17 in the Fellowship Hall. More info coming later!

We are very pleased to announce that our Leadership Team has expanded during 2021-22. Jenny Ammerman and Char Johnson are helping us make decisions, give awards, find volunteers and participate as leaders! Thanks to them for sharing their time. Other Leadership Team members are Kim Kanuit, Treasurer, Kitty Campbell, Vice Chair, Margaret Rawson and Chair Maureen Trepp. Let Maureen know if you'd like to be on this team!



One Worship Service

A celebration of the
2021-2022 Program Year
& all the gifts of our community
that help us grow





Change



Change is inevitable, as the philosophers say, and we've certainly been experiencing a lot of change in our lives. From changing rules and statistics around Covid-19, to the changes in our denomination, to the changes in our understanding of racism, to the changes in the world order, it has become clear to all of us that nothing remains the same forever. We've all been challenged to utilize the muscles of flexibility and adaptability.

There have been plenty of changes in our congregational life, and we are facing another one with the departure of Jenia as our Director of Children, Youth, and Families. While we are glad that we don't have to say goodbye to her completely, it will be a big change to go from Jenia Strom, staff person, to Jenia Strom, member of the congregation. We will be celebrating her time with us as staff, and there will be an opportunity in the June 5 worship service to participate in this change through ritual. But the reality is that this change will be hitting each of us in different times and

different places. For Jenia, much of that is very much in the front of her mind right now as she creates lists, sets

"The season of spring is a great reminder to us of change ..."

up programs and puts dates on the calendar for events that are after June 5. For us, there will be a new face leading the Children's Message after June 5. For Children's and Youth Councils, there are plans for how members of the council can be stepping into the gap of knowledge and familiarity as a new person comes on board. And there will be a period of adjustment. A new person will have a different way of working, and potentially different areas of strength and gift. Jenia will find a new rhythm of participation. We will get used to saying a new person's name, and we will all inevitably stumble a bit as we do this. Stumbling as we make changes is normal, so in addition to those muscles of flexibility and adaptability, we will be working on our muscles of forgiveness and grace and assuming the best intentions of one another.

Change is inevitable, yes, but it is also a positive sign. Change is what allows us to grow. Change is what allows us to continue to find new ways to be God's people in an ever-changing world. Change allows us to hold to our visions and values while also always reflecting on those visions and values, adding new ones, expanding our understanding, focusing on a particular area for a period of time.

The season of spring is a great reminder to us of change as we watch piles of snow recede, grass turn green, animals raising another generation of young. We know that we will also see storms take down a branch or an entire tree. A duckling might become a bald eagle's lunch. Roads will be blocked by detour signs. Some businesses will close as others open.

Change will involve grief, and we don't always welcome that part of change. I invite us to lean into it. Lean into the grief, lean into the possibilities, lean into the opportunity for reflection. And as we lean, may we find ourselves always growing into who we are becoming.

In Joy,
Becky



3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

Address Service Requested

Phone: 612/721-6231
E-Mail: becky@minnehaha.org
office@minnehaha.org

5/22

Visit us online!
www.minnehaha.org

HOLY WEEK

CELEBRATE EASTER AT MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

WWW.MINNEHAHA.ORG

PALM SUNDAY – APRIL 10
WORSHIP @ 9AM & 11AM
10AM OUTSIDE PROCESSIONAL
& FELLOWSHIP TIME

GOOD FRIDAY – APRIL 15
TENEBRAE SERVICE @ 7PM

2 EASTER SERVICES

9AM: INSIDE WORSHIP WITH ORGAN & CHOIR
11AM: OUTSIDE WORSHIP WITH THE BAND

SUNDAY, APRIL 17

PLUS OUTSIDE FELLOWSHIP & FAMILY
ACTIVITIES @ 10AM

